

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader moving closer to the model — AI shipped into production, not demoed

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

AI Chops — Model Behavior and Agent Workflows

Agent workflows in production: handbook loaded as context, an explicit restricted-topic list in the system prompt, manual operation so a person reads every message first, the send decision always human · Prompt architecture with clarifying-question loops before generation · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Quality targets agreed with the people who use the output, before prompt tuning · Structured rollout and qualitative validation

Agentic Engineering and AI-Product Craft

Design Leadership and Coaching Senior ICs

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Coaching design leads through stakeholder conflict · Hiring and performance calls in both directions · A UX-maturity self-assessment used to align a dissatisfied team with what the organization could actually support

Design Systems and Cross-Platform

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, OKLCH · Live sync to Android and Figma, iOS and web endpoints defined · Storybook · Figma Variables · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

PROFILE

I've designed software for fifteen years and led design teams for more than a decade of that, and I spent the last year moving closer to the model. At Bibel TV that means a support copilot live in production, an AI fundraising system I built solo end to end, and prototypes running on real APIs that engineering ships from. Before that, the prompt-to-database onboarding model I designed for Ninox's founders, design leadership at ChurchDesk, and five years at Datameer serving banks and insurers.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production. A Microsoft Copilot skill I designed and scoped, not a custom build. It drafts viewer letters, emails and social messages in the support handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and the draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry. It is operated manually and embedded in nothing, so a person has already read the letter before the model sees it and every send decision stays human.
- Quality agreed before the prompt was tuned. The support team spelled out what counts as a good draft first. Rollout was fully optional: a week of self-testing, then one-to-one sessions, then team-lead encouragement rather than mandate. Validation on that system was qualitative observation. Complex letters now take minutes not hours, temp staff write in the company voice from day one, and sceptics converted after their hardest case.
- Where a scored evaluation panel exists, I built it. On Aperto: nine criteria, each judged in its own model call, binary, any single failure rejecting the draft — and no golden set, because I removed my own after it hid eight of eleven failures on a chapter it passed.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end. Analyzed past letters against their performance for the seasonality and style patterns that separate the strong from the weak, encoded that into a Claude Project that asks clarifying questions before it generates, built the prototype, then shipped a Claude skill producing follow-up content across in-app notifications, web banners and video scripts.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice. My prototypes run on real APIs, and engineering ships from that code.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Android and Figma are live, iOS and web endpoints defined. One commit reaches every platform, so consistency is structural rather than coordinated.
- App redesign. Leading the iOS, Android and web redesign for engagement and retention, with engineering on the experimentation framework. Direction validated, moving into development.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- A legal deadline, met for the customer automatically. Churches whose websites the platform hosts were given an accessibility law to comply with; what we shipped met it for them, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law. The hard constraints here were legal, not technical.
- Customer-service workflow, designed and initiated. Shared inbox and case management were scoped and specified for parish teams handling enquiries and requests. Only the booking module went live before the M&A centralization.
- Booking built into the platform, not beside it. Inherited as a standalone add-on and delivered on the existing calendar and form builder, so the same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, coordinating 20+ cemeteries at the launch customer.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead. Used a UX-maturity self-assessment to align the team with what the organization could actually support. Hired two.
- Coaching a peer in craft. Coached the design lead through a hard cross-functional relationship, and owned the design system, setting up joint governance with engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation. Partnered with the executive team to productize the shared service center. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog, and I worked with IT on the service-desk and ITSM implementation.
- Methodology transfer. Ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams. Primary stakeholder contact for the program.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years. Two UX designers reporting to me. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.

Research, Experimentation and Distributed Teams

Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach personas inside regulated institutions · A/B testing and experimentation infrastructure · Cross-Atlantic delivery across a six-hour gap · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

- Research inside regulated industries. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach people working inside banks and insurers. Defined component behavior and specs across the design system.
- Design as a business partner. Secured executive support for research and measurably increased UX maturity. Time-boxed strategic initiatives kept strategy and delivery in balance.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Design Consultant · *Ninox Software GmbH* · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany